IT Service Systems Economics Part II

Roles and Responsibilities in ITSM (ClydeBank Technology, 2022)

There are various roles with distinct responsibilities in IT Service Management (ITSM) that were established with the sub-units of the ITSM Processes, such as the teams in Demand Management, Request Fulfillment, and Service Review.

Thus, it is evident that IT professionals play critical roles in ITSM. For example, when ITSM changes are implemented in an organization, it takes more than just changing the paperwork and reporting methods and the way a system is configured. Every IT operation and process requires different roles.

Here is the generalized view on the key roles and responsibilities of ITSM:

Service Manager
Service Managers are somewhat considered the bosses who act in an executive role as they often lead a service team. They shoulder the definition of specific services and how they are delivered in line with business expectations.

It is significant for Service Managers to understand business events beyond IT as ITSM aims to align IT with overall business interests. This is why it can be useful to employ Service Managers coming outside the IT department if they have the necessary technical literacy and working knowledge of the organization's IT capabilities.

Service Managers are used to oversee depending on the size and ambition of the IT employees when the Information Technology Infrastructure Library (ITL) is being used as the ITSM framework. They were tasked to decide how ITIL guidance can be best integrated into the organization, as ITIL is used to provide guidance and not to prepare an organization for an ITIL inspection.

The common methods Service Managers use to determine service needs include:

1. They answer these three (3) basic questions about the customer's expectations. This is done for a Service Manager to at least understand their customer experience.
    - What is the expected service, and how is it delivered?
    - How is the service used?
    - How much does the service cost?

2. They answer two (2) basic questions about the IT department's capability.
    - How is the service supported?
        - A service is considered supported when the IT department's resources are deployed to meet the customer's demands.

          For example, in the Finisar case study, the IT department was tasked with providing enough server space so the customer support team could do its work.

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- How is the service delivered?
    - A service is considered delivered when the IT department produces a product or report that fulfills the needs of a customer.

      The product could be for internal and external customers. A product for internal **customers** includes an essential financial report derived from several databases that are then built into Oracle. A product for **external customers** can be a customizable web page design palette that anyone can use.

Other Responsibilities of Service Managers

Under the Service Transition process, **Change Management** is said to implement new IT services while lessening the disruption to existing services. Service Managers ensure a blackout plan is ready in case the change in the implementation begins to compromise existing services. They must also have a clear assessment of the risk associated with any given change and are also responsible for communicating the important elements of the change to other relevant groups.

Incident Management under the Service Operation process undergoes appropriate analysis of incident and escalations steps. They also restore services in case an interruption happens. Service Managers must restore the service as soon as possible, isolate the cause of the incident, and take action to avoid it from recurring.

Service Team

A service team is a kind of board director who oversees advice and execution during a service change. Their primary responsibility is to keep the Service Manager well-informed of the relevant data and information, such as their involvement with accountability and tracking metrics to determine service performance.

Service Teams are a collection of tech experts, product experts, support personnel, and even executive leadership. Executive leadership includes a **Service Sponsor** that is usually occupied by a party that is directly acquainted with the business side of the company. A Service Sponsor is responsible for setting the budget for services, qualifying associated risks, and setting acceptable service levels.

It is also the Service Team's role to ensure that the service remains effective after implementation. They should also be the first to suggest whenever there are opportunities for improvement of service based on the tracking metrics they have. They are also front-and-center in service design and delivery, so they are expected to play a role in long-term planning and anticipating the evolution of technology and business in the future.

As the Service Manager and Service Team spearhead the ITSM efforts of the company, they need to work well together. Regular meetings and consultations are a must. It is also ideal to consider rotating the Service Manager position to keep new ideas flowing.

External Roles

These are vital roles outside the employed people of an organization. This includes the **IT Service Consumers,** which are all the persons or organizational units who use the IT services; **Prospects,** who are future IT Service Consumers with a defined demand for IT services; and **External Suppliers,** which provide infrastructure and operating supplies for IT services and IT service contributions and outsourcing services under established contracts.

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Here are some of the monthly average salaries for roles and responsibilities in ITSM in the Philippines as of 2023, according to Jobstreet.

Responsibilities	Salary	Responsibilities	Salary
Access Management	P64,000	Request Fulfillment	P25,000
Change Management	P92,000	Risk Management	P90,000
Compliance Manager	P70,000	Service & Validation Testing	P28,000
Demand Management	P25,000	Service Level Management	P56,000
Incident Management	P88,000	Service Portfolio Management	P82,000
Knowledge Management	P48,000	Supplier Management	P68,000
Problem Management	P90,000	Strategy Management	P62,000

Table 1. Average monthly salaries for ITSM responsibilities

The Service Culture (Clark, Johnston, Slack, Shulver, 2021)

Culture in an organization encompasses the practices, attitudes, behaviors, beliefs, and values shared between its members. A **service culture** is the positive consideration of the importance of understanding good service as well as the appreciation for giving good service to internal and external customers.

Influences of Service Culture

1. **Influence on how an organization is seen**: There are efforts put into play in creating an organization's brand, but it is only put to the test based on how customers are treated and their overall experience, from website experience to ordering until after-sales support.

   A strong service culture shares what is seen as essential at each stage of the customer's experience, as this ensures the consistency of the message about what the service stands for. A consistent message could only help to establish the brand further.

   According to Campaign's list of Southeast Asia's Top 50 brands in 2023, Shopee leads the top brands with an 81% customer experience score. It is said that Filipino shoppers chose this as the brand best optimized for customer experience across all its online and offline touchpoints. This is a testament to the service culture of Shopee in establishing its brand in the e-commerce industry.

2. **Influence on Operation's Effectiveness:** A service culture reflects an organization's core values, including how business is done and how people interact as a team and treat each other. These have an impact on how well an operation creates its services.

   It causes problems if the operation's culture does not align with its vision and strategy; this is why a strong service culture keeps the core values at the forefront of its day-to-day operation activity. However, inconsistencies may still grow if the imposed culture is different from reality, such as enforcing a culture on its employees rooted in doing the right thing for the customers. Still, the organization is just focused on meeting sales targets.

   Another example was in April of 2023, an exposé by Senator Risa Hontiveros was made about the scam hubs where foreign nationals from Indonesia, Vietnam, Cambodia, Myanmar, and other South Asian and African countries were duped into performing scams.

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One Indonesian national shared that he saw a digital marketing ad position on Facebook, but when he arrived in the Philippines, he was told to scam other Indonesians.

3. **Influence on how employees feel about their jobs:** A service culture can turn its employees into advocates of the organization in ways that address fair wages and reasonable working conditions. Otherwise, they become critics of the organization.

   Employees want to feel that what they do matters. This can be achieved by developing a service culture that recognizes excellent work from individuals and teams. A strong service culture with a shared vision also helps retain the best employees and attract the best recruits.

   Lazada Philippines earned a prestigious Great Place to Work Certification based on Fortune's 100 Best Companies to Work For in 2023. More than 90% of its employees recommend it as a fantastic workplace and envision themselves staying in the next two (2) years. This is on a basis that transcends parties and amazing benefits but also based on the trust employees have in their leaders, their pride in their jobs, and the happiness they experience with their colleagues.

4. **Influence on how operation learns and adapts:** Organizations willing to learn and adapt to sudden circumstances are more likely to survive and thrive in the long run. But this requires comparing what is happening inside and outside the organization with what *should* be happening. There must be a clear idea of how a service should be delivered, which should be at the core of the service culture.

   In 2021, IBM Philippines was one of the many companies that transitioned to a work-from-home setup during the height of the COVID-19 pandemic. They utilized technology to assist them, including cloud and artificial intelligence and were able to upskill their employees simultaneously.

A service culture is not just how customers are treated; it also allows organizations to think of how service can be improved.

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